

LUCY E DELANEY

*Junior Faculty Distinguished Teaching Professor
College of Natural and Agricultural Sciences
University of California, Riverside*



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Employment

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA,
RIVERSIDE

Assistant Professor of Teaching, *December 2021-*
Department of Evolution, Ecology, and Organismal Biology

Education

UNIVERSITY OF ILLINOIS AT
CHICAGO

PhD in Ecology and Evolutionary Biology (*Fall 2021*)
How do we understand natural selection?
Advisors: Joel S. Brown and Boris Igić

HUNTER COLLEGE

MA in Molecular and Cellular Biology (*2016*)

JOHN JAY COLLEGE OF
CRIMINAL JUSTICE

BS in Forensic Molecular Biology, Philosophy (*2012*)

Teaching Activities and Honors

HELLMAN FELLOWSHIP

2024-2025 Selected Fellow
Provides financial support to junior faculty who exhibit potential for great distinction in their area of expertise.

JUNIOR FACULTY EXCELLENCE
IN TEACHING AWARD

2024 Recipient
Nominated by the Department of Evolution, Ecology, and Organismal Biology and awarded by the UCR Academy of Distinguished Teaching.

FACULTY LEAD FOR
RIDLE 4X AND HHMI IE3

2023-2024 Elected Faculty Cohort Lead
A collaborative faculty development program hosted by XCITE with funding from HHMI, centered on the development of equitable and inclusive pedagogy in introductory science courses.

DEEP TEACHING RESIDENCY
PROGRAM

2022-2023 Selected Fellow
An NSF-funded year-long faculty development program evaluating how instructor self-awareness, students' personal histories, and broad social structures impact the development of an equitable pedagogy.

GRADUATE STUDENT
EXCELLENCE IN TEACHING,
MENTORING, AND SERVICE

2021-2018 Four Awards
Recognition for excellence in teaching and mentoring at the campus (1) and departmental level (2), along with recognition for service in the transition to online instruction during Covid (1).

University Teaching

Find a repository of syllabi for all past and present UCR courses [here](#).

MENTORSHIP	Brittney Nguyen, PhD Candidate	Fall 2023–present
	Theo Tran, Honors Capstone student	Spring 2025–Spring 2026
	Arnav Kacker, undergraduate student	Fall 2023–Spring 2025
COURSE REDESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT	Online modality redevelopment	Fall 2025–Present
	Computer Skills for the Everyday Biologist	Winter 2026
	Introductory Evolution and Ecology	Spring 2023–Present
	Introduction to Organismal Biology	Fall 2022–Present
	Cellular Basis of Life  	Spring 2022–Present
	Foundations for the Future  	Fall 2021
INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=285)	Spring 2026
	Cellular Basis of Life (n=280)	Spring 2026
	Introductory Evolution and Ecology (n=199)	Winter 2026
	Computer Skills for the Everyday Biologist (n=50)	Winter 2026
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=192)	Fall 2025
	Cellular Basis of Life (n=288)	Fall 2025
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=288)	Spring 2025
	Cellular Basis of Life (n=288)	Spring 2025
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=285)	Winter 2025
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=170)	Fall 2024
	Cellular Basis of Life (n=272)	Fall 2024
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=158)	Winter 2024
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=217)	Fall 2023
	Cellular Basis of Life (n=284)	Fall 2023
	Population Genetics and Genomics (n=37)	Summer 2023
	Introductory Evolution and Ecology (n=237)	Spring 2023
	Cellular Basis of Life (n=287)	Spring 2023
	Introductory Evolution and Ecology (n=200)	Winter 2023
	Freshmen Advising Seminar (n=22)	Fall 2022
	Introductory Evolution and Ecology (n=239)	Fall 2022
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=192)	Fall 2022
	Cellular Basis of Life (n=285)	Spring 2022
	Introduction to Organismal Biology (n=626)	Spring 2022
	Introduction to Cell & Molecular Biology (n=291)	Winter 2022
	Introductory Evolution and Ecology (n=178)	Winter 2022
	Foundations for the Future (n=25)	Fall 2021
GRADUATE STUDENT POSITIONS	Course Coordinator  	Fall 2021
	Departmental Course Builder  	2020–2021
	Graduate Teaching Assistant	2016–2020
	<i>Genetics (4x), Evolution (3x), Introductory Biology (2x), Ecology Laboratory, Ecology and Evolution</i>	

Publications

Peer-reviewed articles

Delaney, Lucy E & Igić, B. (2022). The phylogenetic distribution and frequency of self-incompatibility in Fabaceae. *International Journal of Plant Sciences*, 183(1), 30–42. 

In production

Delaney, Lucy E (2026.) Public Access Pedagogy: Storytelling as an act of sensemaking in Introductory Biology. In Richard Edwards, Connie Nugent, & Lash Vance (Eds), *Multipedagogies: Lessons from an Innovative Faculty Learning Community at the Intersection of Teaching, Learning and Technology*. Routledge. 

Other works

Delaney, Lucy E. (2022). *Biology 002: The Cellular Basis of Life Course Textbook*. 

Delaney, Lucy E. (2021). *How do we understand natural selection?* [PhD thesis]. University of Illinois at Chicago. 

Delaney, Lucy E. (2012). Nietzsche, nerve stimulation-image connection, and ontology. *John Jay's Finest*, 27, 99–103. 

Funding

2024-2025. \$29,451. PI, *That's Life: A Television Show About Organisms (and a novel approach to introductory biology)*. Hellman Fellows Fund.

2023-2025. \$499,946.41. Co-PI with N. Holt and K. Samuk, *Using a Cluster Hire of Diversity-Invested Faculty to Integrate Biology and Social Justice Teaching*. UCOP Advancing Faculty Diversity.

Presentations, Seminars, and Workshops

April 2025 at CNAS Science Lecture Series | Invited Seminar  

March 2025 at UCR Hellman Symposium | Talk 

February 2025 at UCR Teaching Assistant Development Program | Invited Workshop

December 2023 at RIDLE 4X Showcase Event | Talk  

July 2022 at Howard Hughes Medical Institute | Poster Presentation  

October 2021 at University of Illinois at Chicago | Virtual Seminar  

August 2021 at University of California, Riverside | Virtual Seminar  

July 2021 at Society for the Advancement of Biology Education Research | Virtual Talk   

June 2021 at Society for the Study of Evolution | Virtual Talk   

March 2021 at Midwest Ecology and Evolution Conference |  Best Graduate Talk   

January 2021 at SABER West | Virtual Roundtable  

July 2021 at Botanical Society of America | Virtual Talk   

July 2018 at Botanical Society of America | Rochester, MN | Poster 

August 2017 at microMORPH | Arnold Arboretum of Harvard University | Talk 

Ongoing Teaching Projects

 **A digital community approach to large-enrollment biology lecture** | Outlining the use of a “livestream model” that leverages popular social media apps like YouTube and Discord to produce high-quality online education and community building at scale.

 **Examining the efficacy of two-stage exam models** | Studies the effect of two-stage exams on longer-term content retention, with an emphasis on variations in group composition. (*With graduate student.*)

 **Effect of course design and structure on student sense of belonging** | Uses pre-post surveys over multiple quarters to assess various affective metrics with an emphasis on student sense of belonging. (*With graduate student.*)

 **Accessibility and inclusion in the digital classroom** | A specific focus on the effects of digital instruction on students with disability accommodations. (*With graduate and undergraduate student.*)

Teaching Service Activities

- 🦋 **2023-present** Biology curriculum committee member
- 🦋 **2023-present** Biology major annual assesement committee co-chair
- 🦋 **2024-2025** Member of the Coordinating Committee for General Education
- 🦋 **2024** Invited participant for the *Ask a CNAS Professor* video series
- 🦋 **2024** Invited speaker for CNAS First-Year Scholars Faculty Mixer
- 🦋 **2023-2025** Invited speaker for EEOB graduate student lunch bunch (4x)
- 🦋 **2023** Invited speaker for EEOB 400 graduate seminar (2x)
- 🦋 **2023** Faculty panel speaker for CNAS new student orientation day
- 🦋 **2023** Faculty “Brown Bag” presenter for RISE program
- 🦋 **2022-2023** Faculty mentor for CNAS Graduate Student Mentorship Program
- 🦋 **2022** Journal club facilitator for GradEdge/JumpStart program for new graduate students
- 🦋 **2021** Participant in the Undergraduate Mentoring Program at the Annual Evolution Conference

Selected Professional Experience

Forensic Molecular Biologist at NYC Office of Chief Medical Examiner 2012–2015

Health Research Intern at NYC Department of Health 2011-2012

Field Manager & Administrative Assistant at Working Families Party 2008-2011
New York State political action organization focused on economic justice.

Other positions 2007-2020

Like so many of our students, I held a variety of positions to support myself throughout my scholarly career: cashier, hostess, waitress, receptionist, babysitter, dog walker, bowling alley mechanic, substitute teacher, tutor, and barista. Such experiences inform my mentorship of students that face the unique challenges inherent in balancing work with the pursuit of postsecondary degrees.